PAVAN KUMAR NAYAKANTI

+91-9440493097 | pavan.nayakanti@hotmail.com | linkedin.com/in/pavan-nayakanti | github.com/pavannayakanti | Hyderabad, India

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Director-level DevOps leader with 20+ years operating regulated FinTech platforms on Azure and Kubernetes. Deep expertise in AKS, Helm-based multi-environment deployments, Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines, SOX/GDPR compliance-as-code, and full-stack observability (Prometheus, Dynatrace, MS Application Insights, Splunk). Scaled global SRE organisations from 4 to 40 engineers across ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO, and RBC -- with blameless postmortem culture, MTTR reduced 40%+, and on-call governance for 35-member teams. Strong track record of engineering compliance directly into delivery pipelines (audit trails, approval workflows, zero manual workarounds) for regulated financial services clients. Ready to own the DevOps platform charter as a Director and help establish Hyderabad as a world-class engineering hub.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) & CKAD | Azure DevOps & GitHub Actions CI/CD | Helm & Multi-Environment GitOps Deployments | Terraform IaC (Azure & AWS) | Ansible Configuration Management | Compliance-as-Code (SOX, GDPR) | DevSecOps -- SAST/DAST/IAST, SonarQube, JFrog | SRE -- SLOs, On-Call, Blameless Postmortems | Observability -- Prometheus, Dynatrace, AppInsights, Splunk | AIOps & Automated Remediation | FinTech Regulated Environments | GCC Build-Out & Global Team Leadership

WORK EXPERIENCE

IRIS Software

Sep 2020 -- Present

Sr. Specialist -- Cloud Practice & SRE Lead | India (Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO)

- **SRE Leadership & MTTR Reduction (ADP):** Scaled ADP's SRE organisation from 4 to 40 engineers across India, Canada, and the US. Defined SLOs, SLIs, and error budgets; instituted blameless postmortem culture; managed on-call rotations and escalation frameworks for a 35-member SRE team. Reduced MTTR by 40%+ through AIOps-driven automated remediation via Dynatrace and Ansible.
- **Full-Stack Observability (ADP):** Deployed Prometheus and Grafana alongside Dynatrace and MS Application Insights for full-stack observability -- real-time alerting pipelines, root cause analysis, and proactive bottleneck identification across network, application, and infrastructure tiers. Established Chaos Engineering practices using Keptn.
- **Helm-Based Deployment Orchestration Platform (modeas):** Architected and delivered a deployment orchestration platform across multi-environment Kubernetes estates (dev, staging, production) using Kubernetes and Helm with environment-specific overlays, rollback capability, and deployment traceability -- 200+ builds/deployments per hour, eliminating 10,000+ manual operational hours annually.
- **Cloud Migration & FinOps (BMO):** Led end-to-end on-premise to AWS migration for BMO CCB -- CDK-enabled pipelines across ECS Fargate and Lambda, HA/DR built in from day one. Drove FinOps: rightsized workloads, eliminated unused resources, reduced cloud waste across the AWS estate.
- **Platform Engineering Build-Out (Charles Schwab):** Built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from the ground up as IRIS India-side delivery lead -- SRE practices, reliability reviews, incident governance, and on-call runbooks. Delivered 99.9% release reliability; aligned cross-platform artifact deployment across the TD Ameritrade merger.
- **GenAI & AI-Assisted Operations (BMO):** Designed and deployed GenAI risk summarisation assistants on AWS Bedrock using event-driven pipelines, reducing manual analysis effort and accelerating regulatory insights delivery.
- Conducted quarterly enterprise-wide training sessions for up to 200 participants per 20-hour session; recognised as IRIS Certified Trainer for Q2 & Q3 2024.

IRIS Software

Jun 2018 -- Sep 2020

Automation Technology Specialist | Toronto, Canada (Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance)

- **Compliance-as-Code CI/CD (SOX/GDPR -- 250+ Apps):** Engineered audit trails, approval workflows, and change evidence directly into CI/CD pipelines at RBC -- SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory, Jenkins, UrbanCode, and GitHub enforcing SAST/DAST/IAST scanning and SOX/GDPR change control gates across 250+ applications. Zero manual compliance workarounds.
- **DORA Framework Adoption:** Inducted DORA across RBC Wealth Management and Insurance via Azure DevOps -- Deployment Frequency, Lead Time for Changes, Change Failure Rate, and MTTR established as engineering health metrics and reviewed quarterly with VP stakeholders. Measurable improvement in delivery performance and production stability.
- **Self-Service Deployment Framework (Robo Deployment Framework):** Designed self-service CI/CD orchestration for Windows services, database deployments (SSIS, Oracle, SQL Server), and enterprise workloads. Automated artifact retrieval and approval workflows via Python and Ansible. Application onboarding: 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction) across 60+ teams.
- Established SRE principles within RBC's DevSecOps programme -- observability standards, incident classification frameworks, and reliability-focused deployment gates across 250+ applications. Implemented Splunk log aggregation and alerting pipelines integrated with CI/CD for proactive incident detection.
- Led enterprise migration of 250+ applications across 60+ teams from CA SCM/Harvest to GitHub. Contributed to ~$200K in new project acquisitions through pre-sales leadership at RBC subsidiaries.

IRIS Software

Feb 2017 -- Jun 2018

Automation Architect | Toronto, Canada (Clients: Insurance & Capital Markets)

- Designed fault-tolerant, container-orchestrated deployment pipelines using Kubernetes and Helm -- zero-downtime rollouts across capital markets platforms with RBAC and resource governance.
- Led RPA practice delivery automating 80+ applications across heterogeneous stacks (Java, NodeJS, Kafka, Salesforce, Mainframe). Contributed to $478K SOW closure and $180K Capital Markets engagement.

TechMahindra Pvt. Ltd.

Jul 2015 -- Feb 2017

Technology Manager | Noida, India (Client: Adobe)

- Led end-to-end data migration (Informatica to SQL Server 2012), SAP HANA upgrades, and zero-downtime data centre relocation for Adobe -- full plan, execution, and cutover with no production impact.

Microsoft Corporation

Jul 2007 -- Dec 2014

Sr. SDET -- QA, Automation & Production Engineering | India

- Full production ownership of Sales & Marketing platforms serving US, EMEA, and APAC -- 99.99% uptime sustained over 7 years. Built QA automation frameworks integrated with CI/CD; managed incident response, RCA, and infrastructure administration (Windows/Linux). Supported 200% user growth through cloud migration and self-healing architectures.

KEY PLATFORM INITIATIVES

Compliance-as-Code CI/CD -- RBC (250+ Apps, SOX/GDPR)

DevSecOps -- SAST/DAST -- Audit Trails -- Azure DevOps

Engineered SOX/GDPR compliance directly into CI/CD pipelines across 250+ RBC applications -- SonarQube, JFrog, Jenkins, UrbanCode, GitHub enforcing SAST/DAST/IAST and change control gates. Zero manual compliance workarounds. Application onboarding reduced from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction) across 60+ teams.

ADP SRE -- 4 to 40 Engineers, MTTR -40%, AIOps Remediation

SRE -- Prometheus -- Dynatrace -- Ansible -- Keptn

Scaled ADP SRE from 4 to 40 engineers globally. Deployed Prometheus + Grafana + Dynatrace + MS Application Insights for full-stack observability with AlertManager-driven on-call pipelines. Automated remediation via Ansible. Chaos Engineering via Keptn. MTTR reduced 40%+ through blameless postmortem culture and AIOps.

modeas -- Helm-Based Multi-Environment Deployment Platform

Kubernetes -- Helm -- CI/CD -- GitOps patterns

Designed and delivered deployment orchestration across multi-environment Kubernetes estates (dev, staging, production) with Helm charts, environment-specific overlays, rollback capability, and full deployment traceability. 200+ builds/deployments per hour; eliminated 10,000+ manual operational hours annually; 600% deployment cadence improvement.

DORA Adoption -- RBC Wealth Management & Insurance (60+ Teams)

DORA -- Azure DevOps -- Developer Experience

Established Deployment Frequency, Lead Time for Changes, Change Failure Rate, and MTTR as primary engineering health metrics across 60+ RBC teams via Azure DevOps. Quarterly VP-level reviews. Measurable improvement in delivery performance and production stability across the full estate.

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence -- Woolf University 2024

General Management Program (GMP) -- ISB Hyderabad 2022

M.Sc in Computer Science -- Osmania University 2002

B.Sc in Electronics -- Kakatiya University 2000

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD) 2025

Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) 2026

AWS Certified Solutions Architect -- Associate (SAA-C01) 2026

Google Cloud Certified -- Professional Cloud Architect (PCA) 2026

Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate (AI-102)

ITIL® Certificate in IT Service Operations

PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Container Platform: Azure (AZ-305) -- AKS, Azure DevOps, Azure Key Vault, Log Analytics, Application Insights; AWS (CDK, ECS Fargate, Lambda, Bedrock); GCP (PCA); Kubernetes (CKAD), Docker, Helm, Terraform, Ansible

CI/CD & GitOps: Azure DevOps Pipelines, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, UrbanCode; Helm-based multi-environment deployments with environment-specific overlays and rollback; IaC-driven provisioning (Terraform, AWS CDK)

DevSecOps & Compliance-as-Code: SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory, SAST/DAST/IAST scanning; SOX/GDPR audit trail automation, approval workflow pipelines, change control gates; shift-left security integration; ITIL-aligned incident and change management

Observability & SRE: Prometheus + AlertManager, Grafana, Dynatrace, MS Application Insights / Azure Log Analytics, Splunk, Telegraf; SLIs/SLOs, Error Budgets, Chaos Engineering (Keptn), DORA metrics, blameless postmortems

Automation & AI: Python, Bash, PowerShell, Groovy; Ansible automated remediation; GenAI (AWS Bedrock, Azure AI), AIOps; MSc in Artificial Intelligence; AI-102, DP-100

Data & Messaging: SQL Server, Oracle, SSIS; Kafka integration; event-driven pipelines (AWS Bedrock/BCRG); Tableau, Power BI